

FREE BUSINESS AUDIT

The Small Business Revenue Leak Audit

Discover where time, leads, and profit
are quietly slipping away.

01

Customer
Response

02

Repeat
Business

03

Communication
Time

04

Visibility
&
Marketing

05

Operational
Blind
Spots

Built for small businesses in Ogemaw, Arenac & Iosco Counties

Where Is the Money Going?

Most small businesses are not losing money because of one big mistake. They lose it quietly.

A missed follow-up here. An inquiry that sat too long there. A customer who intended to come back but never got a reminder. Hours lost every week rewriting the same emails and messages.

Over time, those leaks compound. And the frustrating part? Most owners are too busy running the business to see where the losses are actually happening.

This audit is designed to help uncover five of the most common places where small businesses unintentionally lose leads, repeat customers, time, and revenue. Some of these will hit close to home. That is the point.

HOW TO USE THIS AUDIT

- Work through each of the five sections.
- Check the boxes that honestly apply to your business.
- Use the scorecard on the final page to identify your biggest leak.
- You do not need to fix everything at once. One system fixed can make a measurable difference.

WHAT THIS AUDIT COVERS

01	Customer Response Leaks	<i>The 'I'll get back to them later' problem</i>
02	Repeat Customer Leaks	<i>You already paid to earn their trust. Did you keep it?</i>
03	Communication Time Leaks	<i>Death by a thousand small tasks</i>
04	Visibility & Marketing Leaks	<i>'We're good at what we do. People just don't know.'</i>
05	Operational Blind Spots	<i>Busy does not always mean profitable.</i>

The 'I'll get back to them later' problem

If a customer submits a quote request Friday afternoon and nobody responds until Monday, they have probably already contacted someone else. That is especially true in contracting, service work, repair, and seasonal industries.

QUICK AUDIT

- ☐ Do all customer inquiries get a response within 24 hours?
- ☐ Is follow-up handled by a system, or does it rely on memory?
- ☐ Are leads sitting unanswered in email inboxes?
- ☐ Do employees know exactly who follows up and when?
- ☐ Could an automated first-response message buy time during busy periods?

REVENUE LEAK INDICATOR

One missed quality lead per week can compound into \$10,000–\$50,000+ in lost annual revenue for a contractor or service business, depending on average job size.

You already paid to earn their trust. Did you keep it?

Most small businesses spend heavily to attract new customers while quietly ignoring the ones they already have. Past customers know you, trust you, and are far easier to win again.

QUICK AUDIT

- ☐ Do you have a system for following up with past customers?
- ☐ Are seasonal customers contacted before busy periods begin?
- ☐ Do you send any re-engagement messages or reminders?
- ☐ Do you know which customer groups generate the most repeat business?
- ☐ Has anyone contacted your customers from two or three years ago?

REVENUE LEAK INDICATOR

A 5% increase in repeat customer activity often generates more net profit than acquiring the equivalent in new customers, because acquisition costs are already paid.

Death by a thousand small tasks

Many businesses lose hours every week rewriting the same emails, answering the same questions, scheduling manually, and creating content from scratch. Individually those tasks feel small. Collectively they are enormous.

QUICK AUDIT

- ☐ What communication tasks does your team repeat every single week?
- ☐ How many hours go toward manually answering the same common questions?
- ☐ Are employees recreating messages, posts, or documents repeatedly?
- ☐ Could templates or AI-assisted drafting reduce that workload?
- ☐ Is scheduling done manually when it could be automated?

REVENUE LEAK INDICATOR

Teams that reduce repetitive communication tasks by even 3–5 hours per week free up time that can be redirected toward growth, sales, or customer service.

'We're good at what we do. People just don't know.'

This is extremely common in rural communities. Good businesses assume word of mouth will do the work. Sometimes it does. Meanwhile, competitors stay visible, customers forget, and social pages go quiet for weeks.

QUICK AUDIT

- ☐ Does your business post to social media on a consistent schedule?
- ☐ Do you know which content actually drives calls or visits?
- ☐ Are promotions and campaigns tied to seasonal demand?
- ☐ Do customers hear from your business between transactions?
- ☐ Is your Google Business profile complete and regularly updated?

REVENUE LEAK INDICATOR

Inconsistent visibility creates inconsistent revenue. Businesses that post consistently and stay top-of-mind often outperform better-resourced competitors.

Busy does not always mean profitable.

Some businesses work incredibly hard while having very little visibility into what is actually driving profit. The information exists inside your operations. It just has not been organized yet.

QUICK AUDIT

- ☐ Do you know which services or products generate the highest margins?
- ☐ Can you identify slow periods before they hit cash flow?
- ☐ Do you track customer trends or repeat purchase patterns?
- ☐ Are business decisions made from data or from gut feeling?
- ☐ Do you have a clear view of where your team's time actually goes?

REVENUE LEAK INDICATOR

Most small businesses already have the data they need to make better decisions. It is sitting in their systems, unorganized and unused.

Your Revenue Leak Scorecard

Rate each category honestly. This is for your eyes only. The goal is to identify your single biggest leak so you know where to focus first.

Score	What it means
1 – 2	Major problem. This is likely costing you money right now.
3	Inconsistent. Sometimes works, sometimes doesn't.
4 – 5	Strong system already in place.

Category	Score (1–5)	What I noticed
01 Customer Response Leaks		
02 Repeat Customer Leaks		
03 Communication Time Leaks		
04 Visibility & Marketing Leaks		
05 Operational Blind Spots		
TOTAL (out of 25)		

Score Range	What It Suggests
20 – 25	Strong systems. Your biggest opportunity is likely in automation and scale.
13 – 19	Mixed. One or two areas are probably leaking real money right now.
7 – 12	Multiple leaks active. Fixing one can create immediate, measurable impact.
5 – 6	Significant opportunity. The good news: small fixes create big gains here.

You Found Your Leak.

Now Let's Fix It.

You do not need to fix everything at once.

Most businesses see the biggest gains by tackling one workflow, one communication bottleneck, or one follow-up system.

WHAT NORTHERN TECH CURRENTS DOES

Workflow Automation	Map where your time is going and build the automations that give it back.
AI Tools & Custom Agents	Purpose-built tools that know your context, terminology, and workflow.
Team Workshops	Hands-on half or full-day sessions. Everyone leaves with something working.
1-on-1 Coaching	Individual sessions tailored to your role, your pace, and your goals.

Book a Free 30-Minute Call

No pitch. No pressure. Just a conversation about where your business is and what would actually help.

989-787-0260	NorthernTechCurrents.Net	linkedin.com/in/Mike-Ehinger
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Serving small businesses across Ogemaw, Arenac & Iosco Counties